

Proctor Guide — answers & scoring

This is the answer key. Score each team's workbook — each use case out of 100, total out of 400. Several valid architectures exist: score the reasoning, not an exact product match. Reward answers specific to Cedarline; don't reward blank, vague, or category-only answers.

How to score each use case (0–100)

- **Products** — right / appropriate, named not category: up to 50 (~25 per concern).
- **SE reasoning** — addresses the concern AND says how it helps, specific to Cedarline: up to 50 (~25 per concern).

90–100 Expert — right products both concerns; reasoning turns on Cedarline's specifics.

75–89 Strong — right products; sound reasoning; some generic.

50–74 Developing — products mostly right; reasoning thin or one concern weak.

25–49 Weak — category not a product, or restates the problem.

1–24 Minimal / 0 blank.

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USE CASE 1 OF 4 · DETECTION & UNKNOWN THREATS

AI Security

Something landed on a billing workstation and dwelled for four days. Signature-based tools had nothing to match, and most traffic is encrypted.

Concern 1

“We’re worried traditional signature-based detection won’t catch new or unknown attacks quickly enough.” Four days of dwell time, and nothing to match.

EXPECTED PRODUCTS

Cisco Secure Firewall (Snort 3) with the Encrypted Visibility Engine; Cisco Secure Network Analytics (Stealthwatch); Cisco XDR; Cisco Hypershield; Talos / Secure Malware Analytics.

SE REASONING THAT EARNS FULL MARKS

Behavioural / ML / anomaly detection catches unknown and zero-day attacks WITHOUT a signature; Cisco XDR correlates telemetry to cut a four-day dwell time to minutes.

Concern 2

“We mandated TLS everywhere, so most of our traffic is encrypted and we’ve lost visibility. Broadly decrypting clinical traffic is a compliance non-starter.”

EXPECTED PRODUCTS

Encrypted Visibility Engine (EVE) on Cisco Secure Firewall; Encrypted Traffic Analytics (ETA) via Secure Network Analytics.

SE REASONING THAT EARNS FULL MARKS

Both detect threats inside encrypted traffic without decrypting it — keeping visibility while respecting the compliance ban and avoiding the performance cost.

Cloud Edge

Claims analytics runs in AWS, the patient portal in Azure, data science in GCP — three teams, three mental models.

Concern 1

“We’re deploying across AWS, Azure and GCP, but each cloud has its own constructs and workflows. A policy that means one thing in AWS means something subtly different in Azure.”

EXPECTED PRODUCTS

Cisco Multicloud Defense; Cisco Defense Orchestrator (CDO); Cisco Secure Firewall (virtual / cloud-native).

SE REASONING THAT EARNS FULL MARKS

One policy model authored once and pushed to each cloud’s native constructs — same intent everywhere, one workflow instead of three.

Concern 2

“Nobody can tell us our security posture across all three clouds.”

EXPECTED PRODUCTS

Cisco Multicloud Defense visibility; Cisco XDR / Security Cloud Control.

SE REASONING THAT EARNS FULL MARKS

A single dashboard reports posture across AWS, Azure and GCP together — the exact question no one at Cedarline can answer today.

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USE CASE 3 OF 4 · ESTATE COMPLEXITY

DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall

Mixed-vendor firewalls, three management consoles, and an inherited rulebase from the acquired data centre run by two engineers.

Concern 1

“Our firewall environment has become too complex to manage manually — mixed vendor, three consoles, a change backlog measured in weeks.”

EXPECTED PRODUCTS

Cisco Defense Orchestrator (CDO) + Secure Firewall Management Center; Cisco Secure Firewall; the Secure Firewall Migration Tool.

SE REASONING THAT EARNS FULL MARKS

Collapsing three consoles into one management plane cuts the backlog and manual error — the only version a two-engineer team can sustain.

Concern 2

“We inherited DC-2’s rulebase and nobody can prove what a rule does, so nobody deletes one. Two engineers hold all the knowledge.”

EXPECTED PRODUCTS

CDO rule analysis / hit-count reporting; the Cisco AI Assistant for Security; Firewall Migration Tool rule analysis.

SE REASONING THAT EARNS FULL MARKS

Hit counters plus AI rule analysis show what each rule does and safely retire dead ones — turning tribal knowledge into something the tool documents.

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USE CASE 4 OF 4 · EAST-WEST CONTROL

Macro & Micro Segmentation

Inside the data centre it's effectively open. Segmentation has been attempted three times and died each time on ~10,000 hand-written rules.

Concern 1

"We don't feel we have enough control over east-west movement inside the data centre — any workload can reach almost any other."

EXPECTED PRODUCTS

Cisco Secure Workload (Tetration); Cisco Hypershield; Cisco Secure Firewall for macro-segmentation.

SE REASONING THAT EARNS FULL MARKS

Secure Workload auto-discovers application dependencies and GENERATES the micro-seg policy — no one hand-writes 10,000 rules — while Hypershield enforces it autonomously in-kernel (eBPF).

Concern 2

"Once an attacker gets in, they can move laterally across applications. Enforcing segmentation meant writing ~10,000 rules by hand — so it never happened."

EXPECTED PRODUCTS

Cisco Secure Workload (automated policy lifecycle); Cisco Hypershield (autonomous, self-updating segmentation).

SE REASONING THAT EARNS FULL MARKS

Automation replaces the manual rule-writing that killed the project three times, and contains lateral movement by default.

